

MS DOS Error In XP

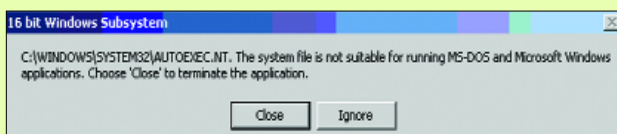
QUESTION
OF THE
MONTH

Q My machine's configuration is: a Pentium 4 2.4 GHz, an Intel 865GBF original motherboard, 256 MB of DDR 400 Zion RAM, a 40 GB Samsung HDD (7,200 rpm). I am using Windows XP professional with FAT32. Other software on my machine include Office 2000, Norton AntiVirus 2005, AutoCAD 2000 and AutoCAD 2004.

Everything was fine, and one fine morning I received a peculiar error, in the screen alongside. I cannot find any solution for it and it is not possible for me to format and reload XP because there is a huge amount of data in there.

Bishwajit Laha

A First try re-installing the MS-DOS based application that causes this error: Go to Start>Run. In the Open box, type in "cmd", and click OK. At the command prompt, type in the following commands, pressing [ENTER] after each command:



```
expand CD-ROM Drive Letter:\i386\config.nt_
c:\windows\system32\config.nt
expand CD-ROM Drive Letter:\i386\autoexec.nt_
c:\windows\system32\autoexec.nt
expand CD-ROM Drive Letter:\i386\command.co_
c:\windows\system32\command.com
exit
```

Now try re-installing the program.

If that does not fix it then start Notepad. In Notepad, type in:

```
dos=high, umb
device=%SYSTEMROOT%\system32\himem.sys
files = 40
```

Save the file with the name 'Config.nt'.

Now again open a blank document in Notepad and type in the following entries:

```
@echo off
lh %SYSTEMROOT%\system32\mscdexnt.exe
lh %SYSTEMROOT%\system32\redir
lh %SYSTEMROOT%\system32\dosx
SET BLASTER=A220 I5 D1 P330 T3
```

Save the file as 'Autoexec.nt'. Now locate the 'Config.nt' file, and copy it to the %SYSTEMROOT%\System32 folder.

Do the same with Autoexec.nt and command.com, and restart your computer. This should fix your problem.

do not have access to another computer, follow these steps: Go to Start>Run, and in the box type in "cmd". In the DOS prompt that appears, type in "shutdown -i". Make sure to enter a space between 'shutdown' and the hyphen. Press [ENTER]. The Shutdown Settings window will appear. In the first box, click Add, and type in your computer's name (To find out your computer's name, right click on My Computer and click on the tab that says 'Computer Name'). Beneath, in the box that says '20' (seconds), type in '9999'. In the box beneath that, which says 'Comment', type in anything and click OK. This will increase your time on the Internet to 2.45 hours. You can then connect to the sites listed above and download the tools to clean your system.

"Pixel Shader"?

Q I have an Intel 2.4 GHz P4 CPU with 256 MB of RAM and a GeForce4 128 MB. While playing *Splinter Cell: Pandora Tomorrow*, my machine gives an error: "Inadequate pixel shader support." Also, in 3D Mark Pro, it gives a Direct3D error with a 'pixel shader' problem. How can I play the game?

Avik

A Your graphics card does not support pixel shader—a graphics function that calculates effects on a per-pixel basis, giving ambience and a look of realism to the displayed image. You would need to upgrade it to at least a GeForce4 Ti card. If you are upgrading, go for a higher-end card, say the GeForce FX5950. If you are looking for a slightly cheaper card, try the GeForce FX 5200 or the FX 5700, or the 9600 Series from ATI.

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Upgrade, Upgrade, Upgrade!

Q I have a Compaq Presario 3600m machine with a Pentium 4, 1.5 GHz processor, 128 MB of SDRAM, and an nVidia Vanta graphics card with 16 MB of memory. My problem is, of late, no games seem to work on my PC. The error messages mainly show that my hardware does not support my games. *Max Payne 2* was the last game that worked fine. After that, whether it is *NFS Underground*, *Doom* or *FIFA 2005*, it does not work. Will I have to buy a new computer, a new processor, or a new graphics card?

Anjan Jyoti Bora

A The problem lies mainly with your RAM and your graphics card. You have not mentioned what motherboard you are using, but we think it will not support DDR RAM. The best solution would be to go for a complete overhaul of your system, wherein you upgrade to a P4 2.4 or 2.8 with at least 256 MB of DDR 400 RAM, and a decent 64 MB graphics card, say a GeForce 5700 Ultra. That should let you play all the latest games at fairly decent settings. For a full comparison and specification, check out the graphics cards shootout in the January 2005 issue of *Digit*.

If you do not want to go in for a complete overhaul, you could go in for a GeForce4 Ti card, which should let you play quite a few of these games at the minimum settings. Make sure to check what AGP slot your motherboard supports—8x or 4x. 8x is backward compatible with 4x, but there is no point in buying an 8x card if you cannot use it to its full potential. ☐